



THIS IS **UNDAC**

United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination



Photos on cover / first page
UNDAC





The United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC)

system is a part of the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA). It serves as the international response system for sudden-onset emergencies, such as an earthquake or a flood, and is designed to help the United Nations and governments of disaster-affected countries during the first phase of an emergency.



ABOUT OCHA

OCHA is the part of the United Nations Secretariat responsible for bringing together humanitarian actors to ensure a coherent response to emergencies. OCHA's vision is one of a world that comes together to help crisis-affected people rapidly get the humanitarian assistance they need. Our mission is to coordinate the global emergency response to save lives and protect people in humanitarian crises. We advocate for effective and principled humanitarian action by all, for all.

United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination



Türkiye, Earthquake Response
February 2023
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THE TEAM

An UNDAC team can be deployed at very short notice (24-48 hours) anywhere in the world.

The UNDAC system is designed to support national governments, the UN in-country, Humanitarian Coordinators and Humanitarian Country Teams, and incoming international responders with coordination during the first phase of a sudden-onset emergency. It also aims to advise and strengthen national and regional disaster response capacity.

UNDAC teams are equipped to be self-sufficient.

They are trained in various skills, such as coordination, needs assessments and information management. The teams also advise and strengthen national and regional disaster response capacity.

When required, an UNDAC team establishes and runs an On-Site Operations Coordination Centre (OSOCC) and a Reception and Departure Centre (RDC), which provide a platform for cooperation, coordination and information management for international humanitarian response agencies and national responders. First responders use the Virtual OSOCC website for real-time information exchange during ongoing emergencies.



MANAGEMENT

The UNDAC system is managed by OCHA's Emergency Response Section (ERS) in the Response Support Branch (RSB).

As well as working with OCHA regional offices and other parts of OCHA, ERS works with UNDAC national focal points. ERS also acts as the secretariat of the International Search and Rescue Advisory Group (INSARAG), which is the global network of countries and organizations dedicated to improving standards and coordination in urban search-and-rescue (USAR) preparedness-and-response operations.

READY TO GO WHEN
CRISIS STRIKES

UNDAC System

THE UNDAC SYSTEM CONSISTS OF FOUR COMPONENTS



PERSONNEL

Professional and experienced emergency managers and humanitarian experts made available by their respective governments or organizations, together with OCHA staff. UNDAC team members are specially trained and equipped for their task. **For the devastating earthquake in Haiti in August 2021, the UNDAC team deployed among others civil-military coordinators and environmental management experts that supported the government in responding to the disaster.**



OPERATIONAL PARTNERSHIPS AND EQUIPMENT

Personal equipment and service packages enabling UNDAC teams to be self-sufficient, as well as operational partnerships optimising service provision for the humanitarian community during UNDAC missions. **In 2020, after the extremely powerful impact of hurricanes Eta and Iota in the Caribbean and Central America, the UNDAC team deployed to Honduras and Guatemala with equipment and specialist staff from various operational partners providing logistics, ICT, mapping and assessment and analysis support.**



METHODOLOGY

Predefined methods for coordination, including collection and management of information, coordinated assessment and coordination support structures for the first phase of a sudden-onset disaster. **For instance, following the devastating Beirut Port explosion in 2020, UNDAC coordination and advice to local authorities and government proved effective especially during the height of the pandemic.**



MOBILISATION PROCEDURES

Proven systems to mobilise and deploy an UNDAC team to a disaster site anywhere in the world within 48 hours of request. **For the earthquake response in Albania, UNDAC members were able to arrive to Tirana within 24 hours after the disaster.**

Facts and Figures

SINCE 1993 MORE THAN



2,017

MEMBERS DEPLOYED



324

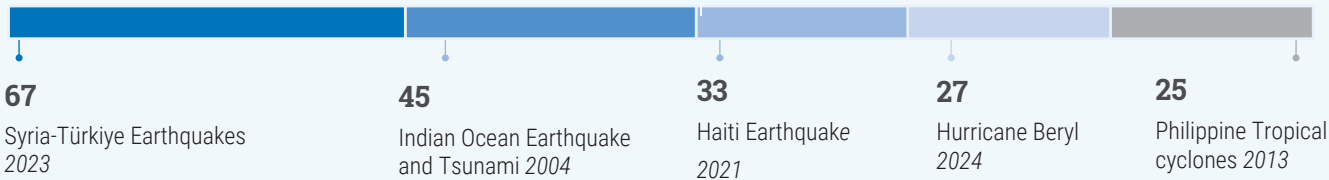
MISSIONS CARRIED OUT



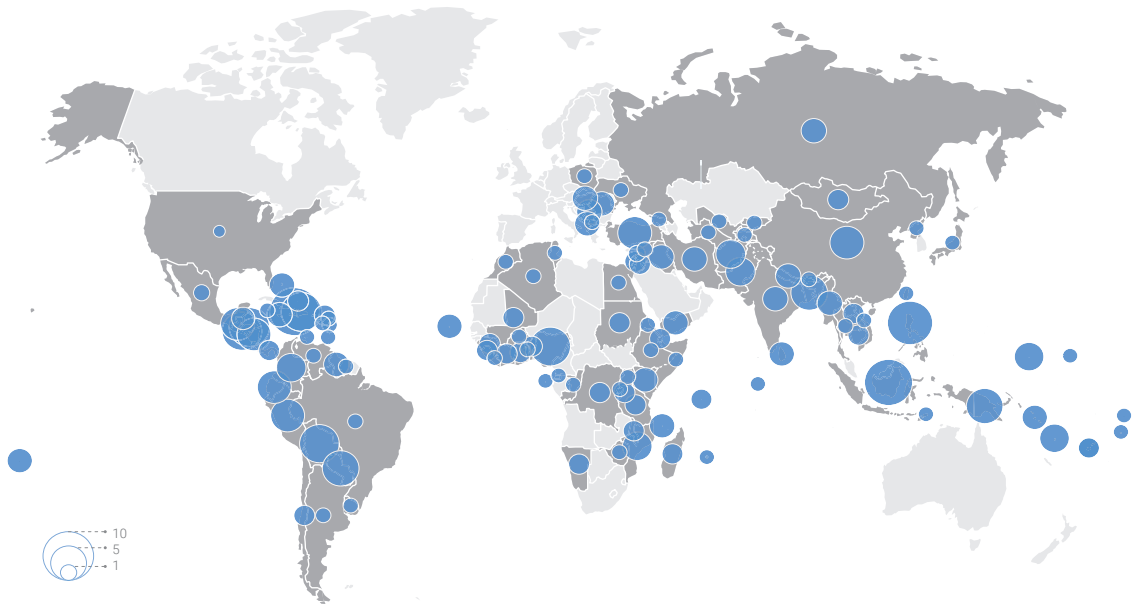
120

AFFECTED COUNTRIES

TOP FIVE DEPLOYMENTS *By team size*

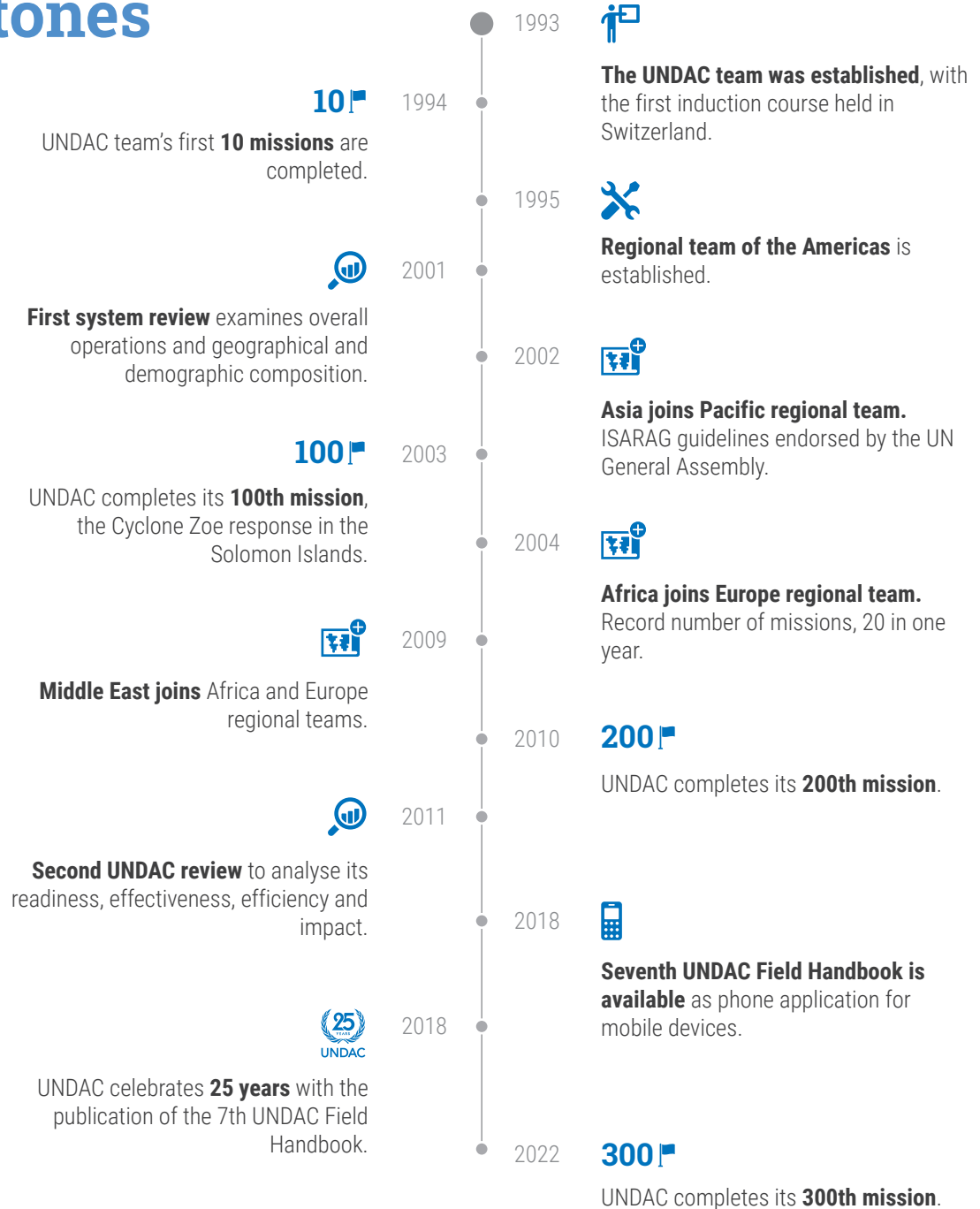


NUMBER OF MISSIONS

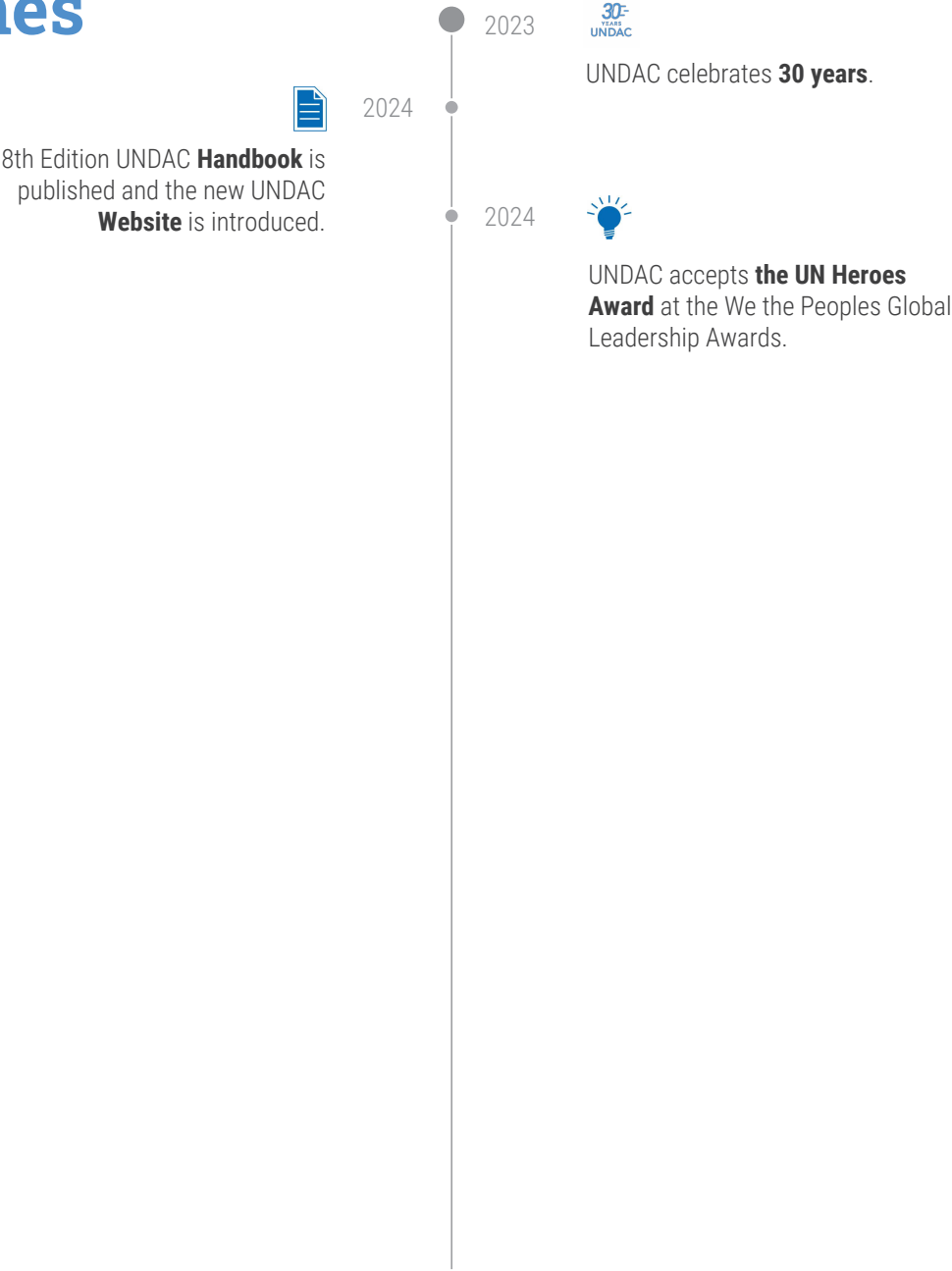


The boundaries and names shown and the designations used on this map do not imply official endorsement or acceptance by the United Nations.

Milestones



Milestones



Methodology

The UNDAC methodology is **based on best practices** from more than 300 missions to over 115 countries since UNDAC's inception in 1993. It can adapt to a

wide range of emergency situations and challenges. The **UNDAC Handbook** and trainings clarify UNDAC's roles and responsibilities in a typical mission cycle.



CORE VALUES

Equal
Committed
Competent
Flexible
Inclusive
Receptive
Operational
Supportive



DISASTER MANAGEMENT

UNDAC bridges the gap between disaster management and humanitarian coordination and provides a unique interface for relevant stakeholders in the immediate phase.



HUMANITARIAN PRINCIPLES

The principles of humanity, neutrality, impartiality and independence are fundamental in the UNDAC system.



LEADERSHIP

UNDAC supports and provides leadership at operational and tactical levels while supporting leadership at strategic levels through establishing systems for decision-making and coordination in the immediate phase.

BUILT ON FOUR CORNERSTONES

underpinning the system and providing the basis for how individual members and deployed teams approach UNDAC mission objectives.

Membership

UNDAC members usually work in disaster management at the national level or in international humanitarian response. Member governments are self-financing countries that hold UNDAC mission accounts with OCHA/ERS, through which funds are

deposited to cover the deployment costs of their national UNDAC staff. Participating countries are sponsored members of the UNDAC system.

UNDAC trainings ensure all active UNDAC members **remain ready to deploy** for response-



To become a member country, the national authority of the interested country should contact the Chief of the Emergency Response Section (ERS).

Contact details are available at:
<https://www.unocha.org/our-work/coordination/un-disaster-assessment-and-coordination-undac/undac-contacts>



Training

and-preparedness missions. As experienced disaster managers and humanitarians, all UNDAC members must attend an induction training, which gives them the basic tools for deployment.

UNDAC members are expected to regularly attend refresher courses in specific areas of expertise, such as **civil-military coordination**, **environmental emergencies** and **on-site coordination**. Trainings are held in all regions and conducted in cooperation with Member States and operational partners.



Partnerships

OCHA works with a range of partners to **enable UNDAC teams** to carry out their activities on the ground. UNDAC operational partners are essential members of the UNDAC system and **include governments, NGOs, private sector and UN**. From logistics and ICT support to assessment and analysis, remote sensing and mapping to technical expertise (environment, health, etc.). Their support extends to all UNDAC associated member organisations such as the UN and governmental agencies, Cluster Lead Agencies and other humanitarian actors collaborating with UNDAC.

UNDAC operational partners include the following

(in alphabetical order), and a **strategic partnership** is also established with the European Commission - Humanitarian Aid and Civil Protection (ECHO) to support UNDAC response and preparedness activities.



Emergency Preparedness

UNDAC teams directly contribute to OCHA's **key preparedness objectives**:

to **strengthen the capacity of national authorities and regional organizations** to access and coordinate international humanitarian assistance effectively, and **to become self-reliant** in coordinating national humanitarian assistance in emergency response.



The **UNDAC system brings together experienced national disaster management experts and international humanitarian professionals** who undertake specific disaster response preparedness missions at the request of interested Governments, and with the buy-in and support of the respective UN Resident Coordinator and UN Country Team.



UNDAC teams contribute to preparedness through capacity-building activities during response missions, and by participating as associates in the capacity-assessment missions of other organisations, such as the Capacity for Disaster Reduction Initiative (CADRI).



Team members act as international observers, advisers or exercise controllers of emergency response simulation exercises.



Many team members help to prepare and host training courses for UNDAC teams, and for other regional and international humanitarian response organizations, such as the EU Civil Protection Mechanism and the ASEAN Emergency Rapid Assessment Team.

Looking towards the Future





The UNDAC system combines local knowledge with international experience to support Governments in the early phase of disaster responses. It continuously adjusts and tailors its approach to fit the operational needs and environment of any given response.

This was the case during the global Covid-19 pandemic, when the UNDAC system recognized that the assistance provided to the affected populations could not remain static. During the pandemic response, the UNDAC system demonstrated a high degree of flexibility in its operations. Of particular note was its ability to transform and provide remote support as a new and strengthened course of action.

This new approach was adopted with the full support of UNDAC's key partners. The strong spirit of partnership among UNDAC members, as demonstrated during the pandemic response, is key towards ensuring the network's continued success

- SEBASTIAN RHODES STAMPA, CHIEF, OCHA
EMERGENCY RESPONSE SECTION

Donors

UNDAC would not be possible without the generous support of the contributing UNDAC Member States listed below:

These donors provide funding to UNDAC mission accounts with OCHA.



Learn more

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ABOUT UNDAC

www.undac.org

ABOUT INSARAG

insarag.org

ABOUT THE VIRTUAL OSOCC

vosocc.unocha.org



The UNDAC system is managed by the Emergency Response Section (ERS) of OCHA in Geneva.

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For more information about OCHA, visit unocha.org